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Maths puzzles for early finishers

Early Finisher Puzzles

Primary 2

Semester 2

Terms 3 and 4

20 single-page puzzles
Almost every puzzle checks itself
One star and two star pages
Teacher answer key included

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Teacher notes (DRAFT)

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What this is

Twenty single-page maths puzzles for Primary 2 pupils who finish their work early. This is Semester 2 of two booklets (Terms 3 and 4). Each page stands alone, so you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages. The pupil needs no help to start.

Which terms

The pages are grouped by the order in which Primary 2 topics are typically taught: this booklet follows Terms 3 and 4, the other booklet follows Semester 1 (Terms 1 and 2). Schools vary, so check your scheme of work: use a page whenever its topic has been taught, from either booklet.

Stars

One star pages practise a topic as it is usually taught (10 pages). Two star pages use the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine (10 pages).

How the pages check themselves

The boxed strip at the foot of each page tells the pupil how to check. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer, and it asks the pupil to see whether the answer makes sense. Every answer box and every letter box must be filled: a box left blank gives no letter, and the check cannot see it.

- **Code word.** The answers give letters that spell a word. The strip gives no hint of the word. Each word can be spelt from its letters in one way only, so answers in the wrong boxes never make another word. A box left empty gives no letter and is not seen by the check.
- **Colour by code.** Each answer is found in a key of five numbers and the part is coloured with that crayon. The pupil counts the parts of each colour and compares with the box on the page; matching parts must share a colour.
- **Letters in an order, a grid or a choice.** Each number, card, picture or choice carries a letter; the letters, read in the order asked, must spell a word. Where one item is left out, its letter is a decoy that is not part of the word.
- **Total.** The whole count must make the total printed in the strip (the graph pages add a second sum).

Marking is not needed. To spot-check, look only at the check strip.

How the checks were tested

A script tried every single wrong answer and every wrong arrangement on every page. Each check rejected at least 95% of them. A wrong answer that spells any of about 129 000 English words counts as not rejected. Two wrong answers at once were not all tested.

Teacher notes: using the pages (DRAFT)

Using the pages

- **Time.** Most pages take 5 to 15 minutes; the colour-by-code pages (S2-20) take longer because pupils colour a picture. Pupils need their own crayons (five colours: yellow, red, blue, green, orange). For a pencil-only copy the pupil writes Y, R, B, G or O in each part; the tally and the matching parts are checked the same way. Light crayons work best: a dark crayon hides the number in the part on a photocopy.
- **If the check fails.** The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.
- **Problem solving.** Some pages (S2-13, S2-19) practise the kinds of question that appear in school tests, such as comparing amounts of money, durations and printed facts, rather than one numbered syllabus outcome. The key tags them problem solving.
- **Stars.** One star: one skill, as usually taught. Two stars: the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine.
- **Drawings.** Pictures of rulers, scales, clocks, coins and notes are original drawings, not to scale unless a page says so. Coins and notes are inspired by Singapore money, drawn larger than real and in black and white.

Photocopying

All pages are black and white with solid lines, so they copy cleanly. Each page is one side only. Pupils write on the page: the boxes are large for young hands. Use A4 and print at 100% (actual size).

Contents: Semester 2

Page	Code	Puzzle	Tier
S2-01	P2-06	Dollars and Cents	1 star
S2-02	P2-16	Writing Money	2 stars
S2-03	P2-23	Which Costs More?	2 stars
S2-04	P2-24	Purse Match	2 stars
S2-05	P2-08	Metres	1 star
S2-06	P2-25	Kilograms and Grams	1 star
S2-07	P2-26	Litres	1 star
S2-08	P2-27	Which Unit?	1 star
S2-09	P2-28	Order the Measures	2 stars
S2-10	P2-07	Time to the Minute	1 star
S2-11	P2-30	Hours and Minutes	1 star
S2-12	P2-29	Time Taken	2 stars
S2-13	P2-31	Time Detective	2 stars
S2-14	P2-32	Shape Patterns	1 star
S2-15	P2-33	Pattern Rules	2 stars
S2-16	P2-34	Meet the Solids	1 star
S2-17	P2-35	Solid Sort	2 stars
S2-18	P2-36	Picture Graph Scales	1 star
S2-19	P2-37	Graph Detective Two	2 stars
S2-20	P2-40	Colour the Butterfly	2 stars

Pages are independent. The footer code shows the page in this booklet and, in brackets, its number in the full set of 40 (P2-01 to P2-40).

What the booklet covers

Money 1.1 counting amount of money in dollars and cents **S2-01, S2-04**

Money 1.2 reading and writing money in decimal notation **S2-01, S2-02, S2-03, S2-04**

Money 1.3 comparing two or three amounts of money **S2-03**

Money 1.4 converting an amount of money in decimal notation to cents only, and vice versa **S2-02**

Length, Mass and Volume 1.1 measuring (length in metres; mass in kilograms/grams; volume of liquid in litres) **S2-05, S2-06, S2-07, S2-09**

Length, Mass and Volume 1.2 using appropriate units of measurement and their abbreviations m, g, kg, ℓ **S2-05, S2-06, S2-07, S2-08**

Length, Mass and Volume 1.3 comparing and ordering (lengths; masses; volumes) **S2-09**

Time 2.1 telling time to the minute **S2-10, S2-12, S2-13, S2-20**

Time 2.2 measuring time in hours and minutes **S2-12, S2-13, S2-20**

Time 2.3 converting time in hours and minutes to minutes only, and vice versa **S2-11, S2-13, S2-20**

2D Shapes 1.1 making/completing patterns with 2D shapes according to one or two of the following attributes (size; shape; colour; orientation) **S2-14, S2-15**

3D Shapes 2.1 identifying, naming, describing and classifying 3D shapes (cube, cuboid, cone, cylinder, sphere) **S2-16, S2-17**

Picture Graphs with Scales 1.1 reading and interpreting data from picture graphs with scales **S2-18, S2-19**

Outcomes practised in the other booklet: Whole Numbers 1.1; Whole Numbers 1.2; Whole Numbers 1.3; Whole Numbers 1.4; Whole Numbers 1.5; Whole Numbers 1.6; Addition and Subtraction 2.1; Addition and Subtraction 2.2; Multiplication and Division 3.1; Multiplication and Division 3.2; Multiplication and Division 3.3; Multiplication and Division 3.4; Multiplication and Division 3.5; Fractions 1.1; Fractions 1.2; Fractions 1.3; Fractions 2.1.

S2-01 (P2-06)

Dollars and Cents

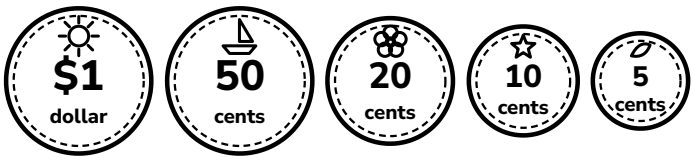
★ Name _____

Topic: Money: counting coins and notes, decimal notation

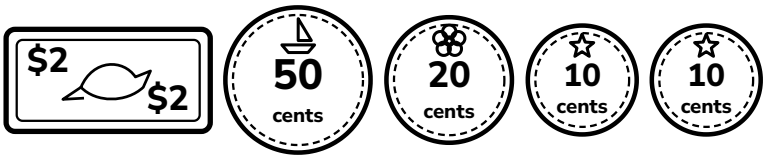
Count the money in each row.
Write the total, like $3.45.
Use the code table.

1. 

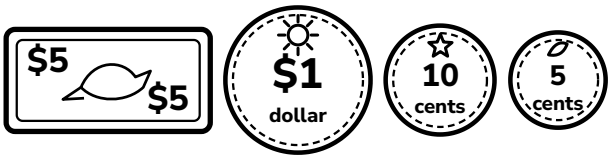
$ ____

2. 

$ ____

3. 

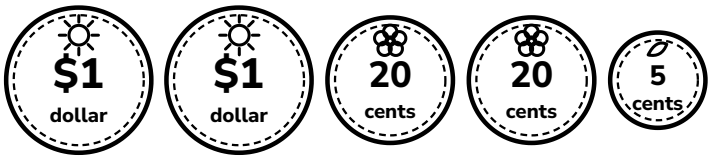
$ ____

4. 

$ ____

5. 

$ ____

6. 

$ ____

Code table

$1.45 = C	$1.85 = A	$2.45 = R	$2.60 = X	$2.65 = S
$2.90 = I	$2.95 = Q	$6.10 = V	$6.15 = L	$10.25 = O

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-02 (P2-16)

Writing Money

★★ Name _____

Topic: Money: decimal notation and cents

Write each amount a different way.
Cents: write a number. Dollars: write like $2.50.
Use the code table.

1 49¢ = $?

$ ☐

2 $9.37 = ? ¢

☐ ¢

3 $7.06 = ? ¢

☐ ¢

4 604¢ = $?

$ ☐

5 224¢ = $?

$ ☐

6 3 dollars and 41 cents = $?

$ ☐

Code table

$0.39 = I	$0.49 = M	$1.49 = Q	$2.24 = E	$3.41 = T
$5.04 = X	$6.04 = N	706¢ = G	937¢ = A	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-03 (P2-23)

Which Costs More?

★★ Name _____

Topic: Money: comparing and ordering amounts

Put the prices in order.
Write the letter of each card in its place.
Set A: lowest first. Set B: highest first.

Set A: the lowest price first.

O	U	B
bag	pencil case	toy car
$6.90	$6.95	$6.50

Set B: the highest price first.

E	C	N
cap	bottle	scarf
$3.40	$3.50	$3.95

Write the letters in order: Set A, then Set B.

Check it. Read the six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S2-04 (P2-24)

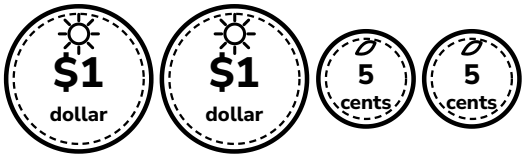
Purse Match

★★ Name _____

Topic: Money: counting coins and notes, matching amounts

Count the money in each purse.
Match each amount to its purse.
Write the letter of the purse.

S



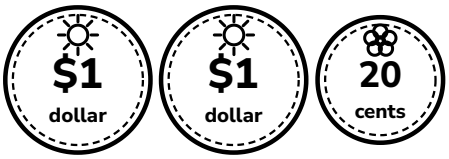
P



C



U



A



M



Which purse holds each amount? Write its letter.

1 **$1.40** ☐	2 **$3.00** ☐	3 **$1.70** ☐
4 **$1.15** ☐	5 **$2.20** ☐	6 **$2.10** ☐

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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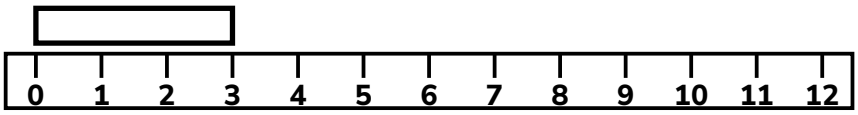
S2-05 (P2-08)

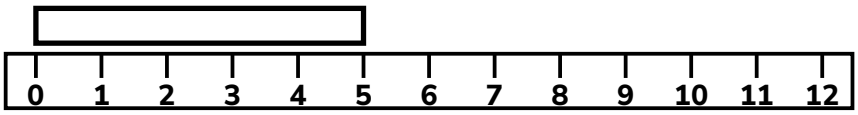
Metres

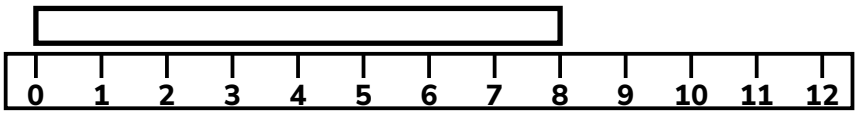
Name _____

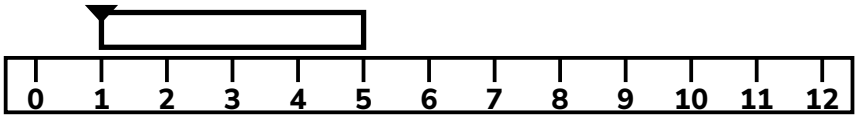
Topic: Length: measuring in metres (m)

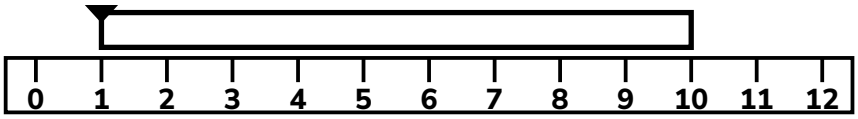
Each tape shows metres.
How long is each thing? Write it in metres.
Use the code table.

1. rope  m

2. wall  m

3. path  m

4. snake  m

5. ribbon  m

Code table

2 = Q	3 = G	4 = N	5 = R	6 = K
7 = Y	8 = U	9 = T	11 = X	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-06 (P2-25)

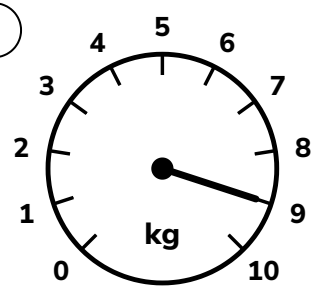
Kilograms and Grams

★ Name _____

Topic: Mass: reading scales in kilograms (kg) and grams (g)

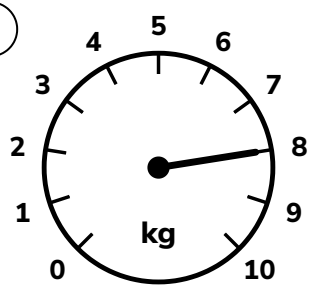
Read each scale.
Write the mass and its unit.
Use the code table.

1



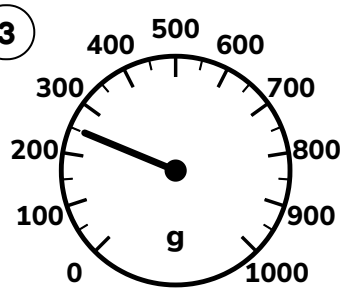
_____ kg

2



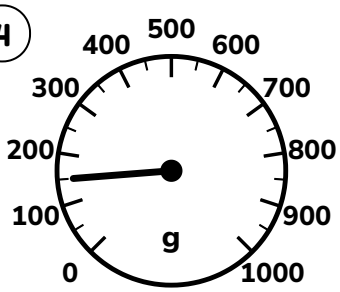
_____ kg

3



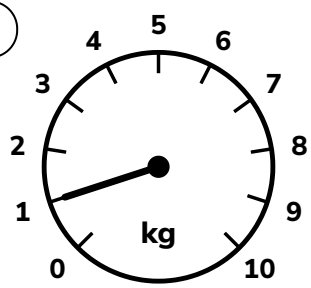
_____ g

4



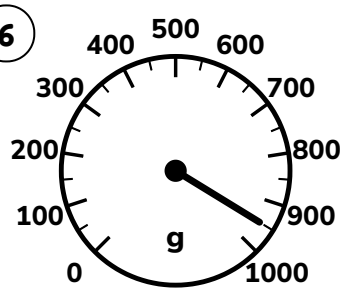
_____ g

5



_____ kg

6



_____ g

Code table

1 kg = R	3 kg = S	7 kg = K	8 kg = I	9 kg = F
100 g = Z	150 g = U	250 g = G	950 g = E	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-07 (P2-26)

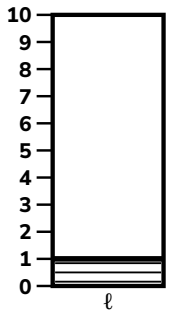
Litres

Name _____

Topic: Volume of liquid: reading containers in litres (ℓ)

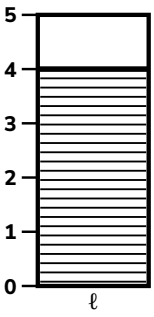
Read the liquid level in each container.
Write the number of litres.
Use the code table.

1



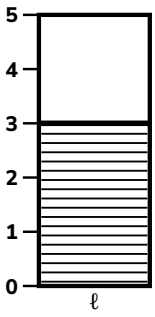
_____ ℓ

2



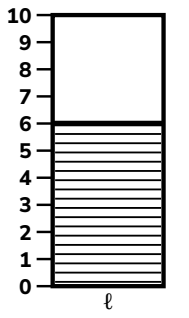
_____ ℓ

3



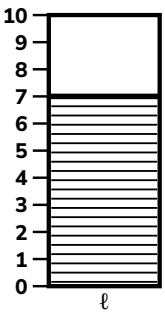
_____ ℓ

4



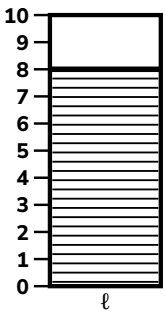
_____ ℓ

5



_____ ℓ

6



_____ ℓ

Code table

0 = Q	1 = F	3 = U	4 = R	5 = X
6 = I	7 = T	8 = Y	9 = P	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S2-08 (P2-27)

Which Unit?

★ Name _____

Topic: Units of measurement: m, g, kg and ℓ

Which unit makes sense?
Circle the letter of the right unit.
Write the six letters in the boxes.

1. A boy weighs 25 ___. **kg** (H) **m** (O) **g** (X)

2. An egg weighs 60 ___. **ℓ** (Z) **kg** (T) **g** (U)

3. A bag of rice is 5 ___. **g** (M) **kg** (N) **m** (B)

4. A melon weighs 3 ___. **ℓ** (S) **kg** (G) **m** (V)

5. A bucket holds 8 ___ of water. **g** (I) **ℓ** (R) **m** (X)

6. A pencil weighs 5 ___. **g** (Y) **m** (M) **kg** (E)

Check it. Write the six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S2-09 (P2-28)

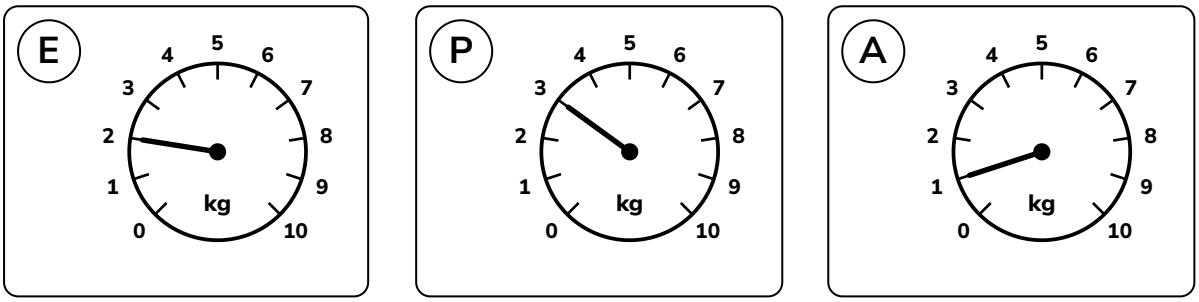
Order the Measures

★★ Name _____

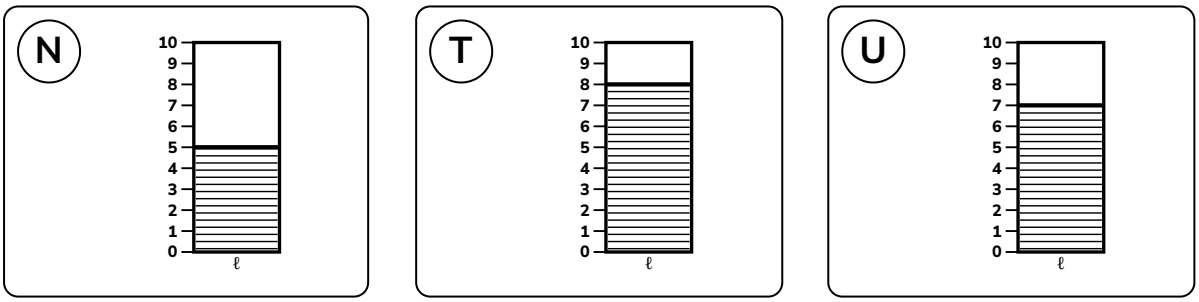
Topic: Mass and volume: comparing and ordering

Read each scale and container.
Put each set in order.
Write the letters in order.

Set A: heaviest first.



Set B: least liquid first.



Write the letters in order: Set A, then Set B.

Check it. Read the six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S2-10 (P2-07)

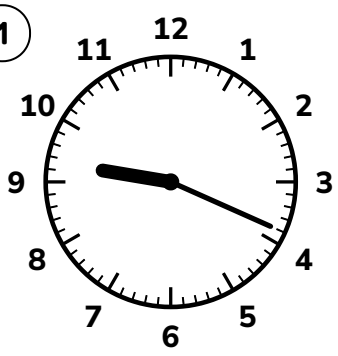
Time to the Minute

Name _____

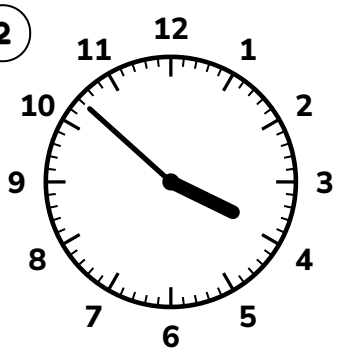
Topic: Time: telling time to the minute

Read each clock.
Write the time, like 3:47.
Use the code table.

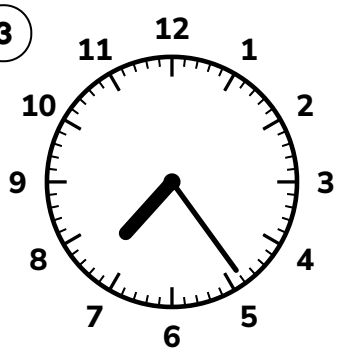
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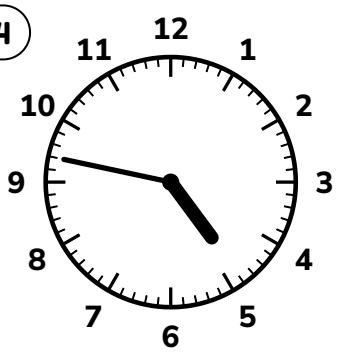
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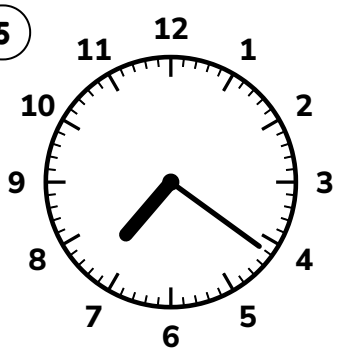
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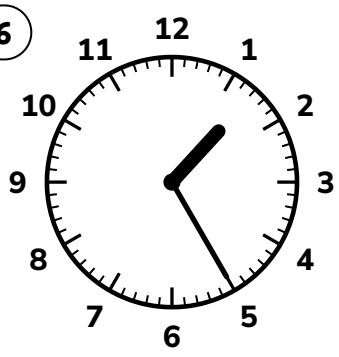
4



5



6



Code table

1:25 = P	3:45 = Q	3:52 = E	4:47 = C	4:52 = J
5:05 = K	7:19 = R	7:21 = U	7:24 = A	9:19 = T

Check it. Write the letters in order.
Do they spell a word?

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S2-11 (P2-30)

Hours and Minutes

★ Name _____

Topic: Time: changing hours and minutes to minutes, and back

1 h = 60 min.

Fill in the missing number.

Use the code table.

1 3 h 30 min = ? min

☐ min

2 250 min = ? h 10 min

☐ h

3 3 h = ? min

☐ min

4 270 min = 4 h ? min

☐ min

5 1 h 25 min = ? min

☐ min

6 185 min = 3 h ? min

☐ min

Code table

4 = O	5 = E	30 = G	33 = B	85 = U
180 = N	210 = T	240 = H	300 = X	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word?

☐☐☐☐☐☐

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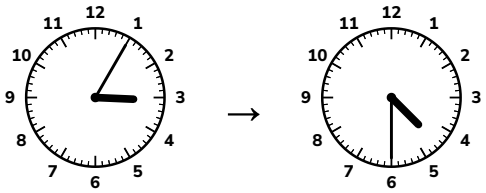
S2-12 (P2-29)

Time Taken

★★ Name _____

Topic: Time: finding how long in hours and minutes

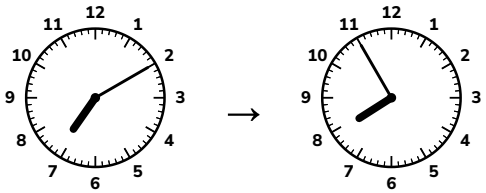
Find how long it took.
Write the hours and the minutes.
Use the code table.

1  → ☐ h ☐ min

2 **Start 6:07 pm. End 6:49 pm.** ☐ h ☐ min

3 **Start 7:37 pm. End 10:44 pm.** ☐ h ☐ min

4 **Start 6:30 pm. End 10:39 pm.** ☐ h ☐ min

5  → ☐ h ☐ min

Code table

32 min = J	42 min = A	45 min = E	1 h 25 min = M
3 h 7 min = I	4 h 9 min = Z	5 h 9 min = Q	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-13 (P2-31)

Time Detective

★★ Name _____

Topic: Time: a timetable, minutes and hours

Read the timetable.
Answer each question in minutes.
Use the code table.

Lesson	Start	End
Science	8:00 am	8:45 am
Reading	8:50 am	9:30 am
Story time	9:45 am	10:20 am
PE	10:35 am	11:10 am
Maths	11:15 am	12:25 pm
Drawing	12:35 pm	1:30 pm

1. How many minutes is Drawing? ☐ min

2. How many minutes is Story time? ☐ min

3. How many minutes from the end of PE to the start of Maths? ☐ min

4. How many minutes are Science and PE together? ☐ min

5. How many minutes from the start of Science to the end of Reading? ☐ min

6. How many more minutes is Maths than Drawing? ☐ min

Code table

5 = N	**15 = T**	**35 = A**	**55 = B**
60 = G	**80 = D**	**90 = I**	**150 = F**

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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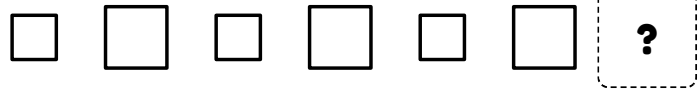
S2-14 (P2-32)

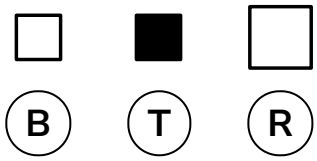
Shape Patterns

Name _____

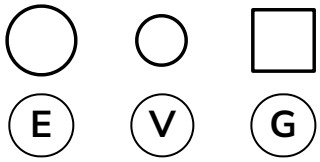
Topic: 2D shape patterns: what comes next?

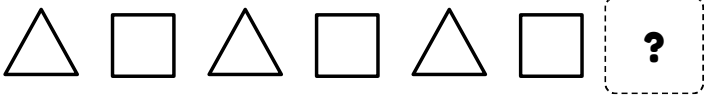
Look at each pattern.
Circle the letter of the shape that comes next.
Write the six letters in the boxes.

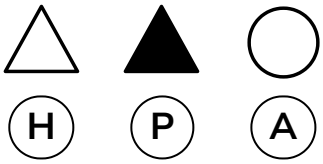
1 



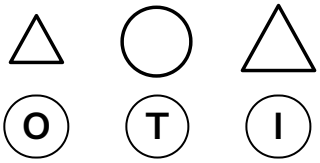
2 



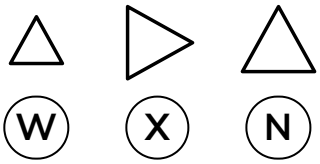
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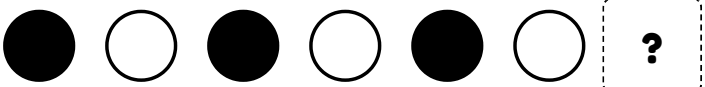


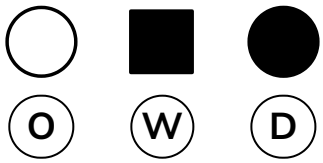
4 



5 



6 



Check it. Write the six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S2-15 (P2-33)

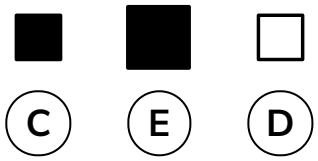
Pattern Rules

★★ Name _____

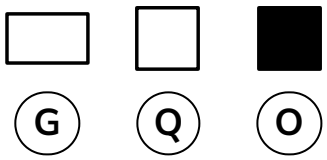
Topic: 2D shape patterns: what comes next?

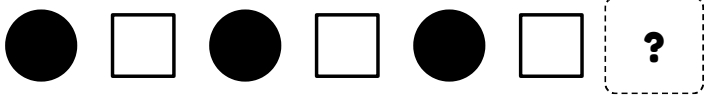
Look at each pattern.
Circle the letter of the shape that comes next.
Write the six letters in the boxes.

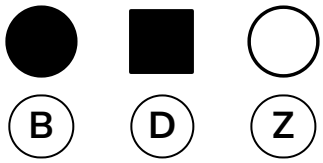
1 

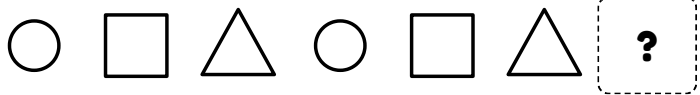


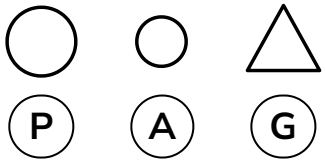
2 



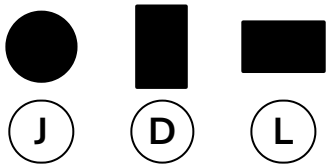
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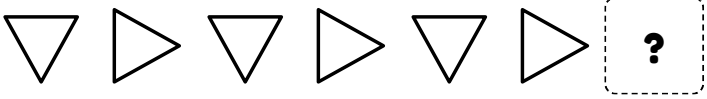


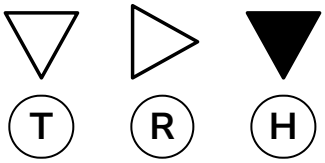
4 



5 



6 



Check it. Write the six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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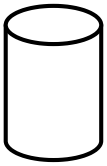
S2-16 (P2-34)

Meet the Solids

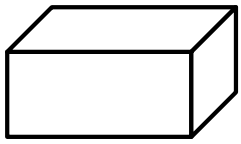
Name _____

Topic: 3D shapes: cube, cuboid, cone, cylinder and sphere

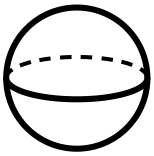
Name each solid.
Circle the letter of its name.
Write the six letters in the boxes.

1 

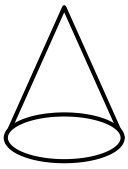
cuboid (G) **cylinder** (B) **cone** (F)

2 

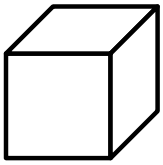
cuboid (A) **cube** (S) **sphere** (H)

3 

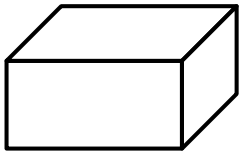
sphere (C) **cube** (W) **cylinder** (T)

4 

cylinder (Q) **cuboid** (V) **cone** (K)

5 

cube (U) **cone** (Z) **cuboid** (T)

6 

cuboid (P) **cube** (J) **cone** (T)

Check it. Write the six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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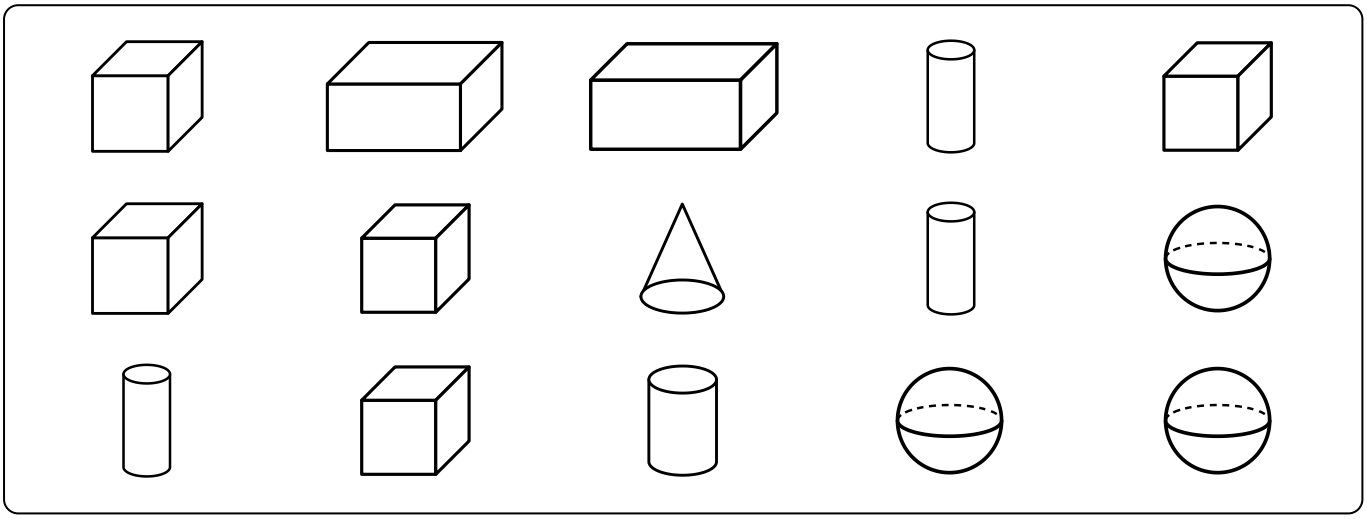
S2-17 (P2-35)

Solid Sort

★★ Name _____

Topic: 3D shapes: sorting and counting solids

Count each kind of solid.
Write the number in its box.
Use the code table.



How many of each? Total: 15.

cube	cuboid	cone	cylinder	sphere

Code table

1 = I	2 = H	3 = F	4 = E
5 = T	6 = J	7 = G	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? Do the counts add to 15?

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S2-18 (P2-36)

Picture Graph Scales

★ Name _____

Topic: Picture graphs with scales: one picture stands for more than one

Read the key. One picture is more than 1.
Answer each question.
Use the code table.

Blue	
Yellow	
Black	
Green	
Red	

Key:  **= 2 children**

1. How many children chose Blue? ☐
2. How many children chose Yellow? ☐
3. How many fewer chose Black than Green? ☐
4. How many children chose Green or Red? ☐
5. How many children in all? ☐
6. How many more chose Yellow than Red? ☐

Code table

6 = Y	8 = N	10 = O	14 = D	18 = Q
20 = K	22 = G	52 = E	54 = B	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-19 (P2-37)

Graph Detective Two ★★

Name _____

Topic: Picture graphs with scales: two rows are covered

Two rows are covered.
Use the clues. Answer each question.
Use the code table.

Melons	
Plums	
Pears	
Mangoes	**covered**
Lychees	**covered**

Key:  **= 10 children**

- There are 2 pictures for Lychees (covered).
- The graph shows 200 children in all.

1. How many pictures for Mangoes? ☐
2. How many children chose Mangoes? ☐
3. How many children chose Lychees? ☐
4. How many fewer chose Melons than Mangoes? ☐
5. How many more chose Plums than Lychees? ☐
6. How many children in all? ☐

Code table

4 = F	**9 = S**	**10 = I**	**20 = M**
30 = L	**40 = A**	**41 = J**	**200 = Y**

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? Do the rows add to the total? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-20 (P2-40)

Colour the Butterfly

★★ Name _____

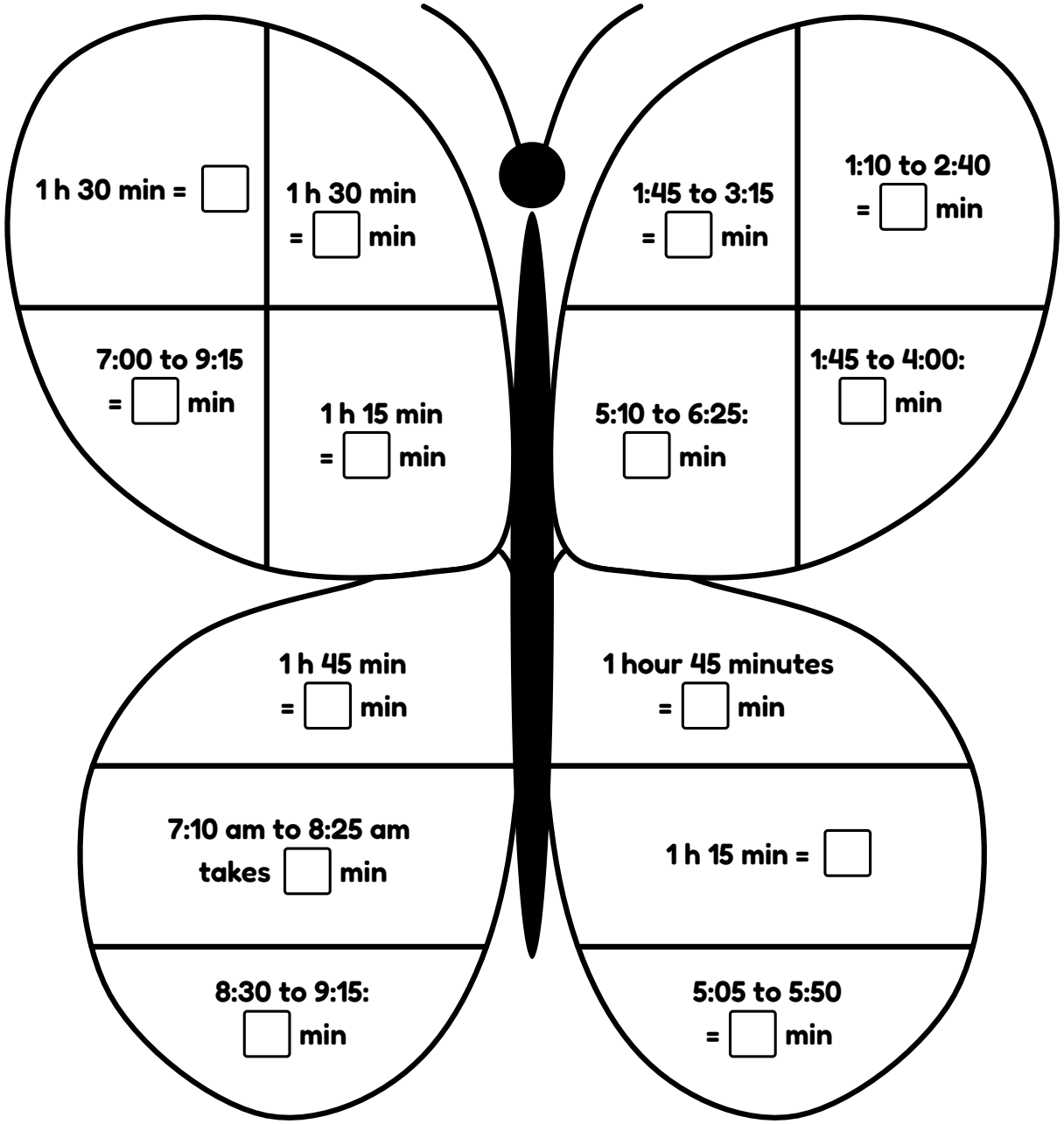
Topic: Time: hours, minutes and how long

Find the answer in each part.

Find it in the key.

Colour the part. No crayon? Write Y, R, B, G or O.

45 min	75 min	90 min	105 min	135 min
yellow	red	blue	green	orange



Check it.
Count the parts of each colour. You should have: yellow 2, red 4, blue 4, green 2, orange 2.
Parts in the same place on the left and on the right have the same colour.

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